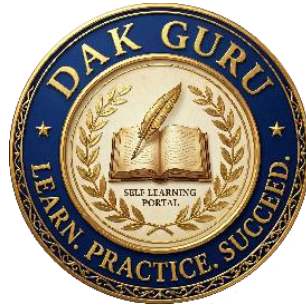




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ESTABLISHMENT NORMS

Comprehensive Study Notes for Departmental Examinations

LDCE — Inspector of Posts (IP) • PS Group 'B' • and allied cadres

*Post-office & RMS establishment • Marathe Time Test • CSI / IPVS / CBS-Finacle
workload norms • GDS (Kamlesh Chandra) • Divisional, Circle & special
establishments — updated and cross-checked edition.*

Revised & Verified Edition

Compiled and published by Dak Guru

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- 1. Nature of the material.** Establishment norms in the Department of Posts are contained in the Postal Manual Volumes, the Establishment Norms compilation, and a large number of Directorate letters, Statistical & Intelligence Unit (SIU) standards, and periodic circulars. Many of these are internal departmental instructions that are not published in any publicly accessible gazette. The figures reproduced here are drawn from the standard reference material used in examination preparation.
- 2. Currency and verification.** Every effort has been made to reflect the position in force. Items that could be independently verified against public sources — notably the GDS (Kamlesh Chandra Committee) wage structure and social-security benefits, the Group 'C' cadre-restructuring ratios, the Multi-Tasking Staff redesignation, the CBS/Finacle and CSI transition, and the October 2025 Speed Post revision — have been checked and, where necessary, corrected in this edition. Internal time-factor and coefficient figures (Marathe Time Test, SIU formulae, CSI/IPVS per-operation norms) generally cannot be verified against public primary sources and are reproduced as the established study figures. They should be cross-checked against the latest Directorate order before being relied upon for any official purpose.
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How to Read These Notes

The notes are organised into fifteen Parts, following the sequence of the establishment-norms syllabus. Within each Part the individual standards are numbered as Chapters, matching the numbering used in the standard reference so that cross-referencing remains easy. Three kinds of highlighted boxes appear throughout:

UPDATE NOTE

marks a substantive change from the older norm to the position now in force — for example, the move from the Point System to the Kamlesh Chandra wage levels, or from Meghdoot to CBS-Finacle. The old position is retained in brackets so you can see exactly what changed and answer either way in the examination.

VERIFIED (CURRENT)

marks a figure that has been independently confirmed as current as of this edition.

Snapshot — verification status of the major updates

Item	Position in these notes	Status
GDS wage structure (TRCA levels)	BPM ₹12,000 / ₹14,500; ABPM & Dak Sevak ₹10,000 / ₹12,000 (Kamlesh Chandra, w.e.f. 01.07.2018)	Verified current
GDS social-security benefits	Gratuity max ₹1,50,000; Severance ₹4,000/yr (max ₹1,50,000); SDBS ₹300/month	Verified current
Group 'C' cadre-restructuring ratios	Corrected to LSG 22% / HSG-II 12% / HSG-I 4%	Corrected
Speed Post Oct-2025 revision	Tariff revised & OTP/registration/online features added (Gazette No. 4256, w.e.f. 01.10.2025)	Verified current
Speed Post workload = "82–188 sec"	Retained as an internal CSI-POS figure, NOT attributed to the gazette	Mis-attribution fixed
MTS / EDA→GDS / Meghdoot→CSI	General factual updates	Verified (general)
Marathe / SIU / CSI / IPVS per-operation time factors	Reproduced as established study figures	Not publicly verifiable

Part I — Establishment of Post Offices

This Part sets out the conditions under which new post offices may be opened, the yardsticks used to test whether an office is financially justified, and the way the income and cost of a post office are worked out. It also covers the revised GDS wage structure that governs the allowances of the staff who man branch offices.

Chapter 1 — Opening of Post Offices in Rural Areas

These norms, effective from 1 April 1991, govern the opening of Branch Post Offices (BOs) in rural India. A proposal to open a rural BO must satisfy three tests together — population, distance, and anticipated income — with relaxed thresholds in difficult terrain.

1.1 Population Criteria

Area Type	Minimum Population
Normal areas	3,000 population (a village or group of villages, including PPO villages)
Hilly / tribal / desert / inaccessible areas	500 (single village) OR 1,000 (group of villages)

1.2 Distance Criteria

Area Type	Minimum Distance from Nearest Post Office
Normal areas	3 km
Hilly / tribal / desert areas	Same 3 km; the Directorate may relax in special circumstances

1.3 Anticipated Income

The anticipated income of the proposed office, expressed as a percentage of its cost, must reach:

Area Type	Minimum Income as % of Cost
Normal areas	33⅓ % of cost
Hilly / tribal / desert / inaccessible areas	15 % of cost

1.4 Desert Development Programme (DDP) Districts

Relaxed norms apply in districts covered under the Desert Development Programme:

- **Rajasthan:** Jaisalmer, Jodhpur, Nagaur, Pali, Barmer, Jalore, Bikaner, Churu, Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Sri Ganganagar (84 blocks)
- **Gujarat:** Banaskantha, Mahesana (8 blocks)

- **Haryana:** Sirsa, Hissar, Bhiwani, Rohtak (26 blocks)
- **Himachal Pradesh:** Lahaul & Spiti, Kinnaur
- **Jammu & Kashmir:** Leh, Kargil

Reference: DG Posts, New Delhi, Lr. No. 1-2/90-P&T dated 20.03.1991.

Chapter 2 — Opening of Post Offices in Urban Areas

The conditions for opening post offices in urban areas were laid down by DG Posts Lr. No. 1-36/77-PRP dated 21.10.1986:

- Initially the Sub-Office (SO) must be self-supporting. At the first annual review it must show a 5% profit to be retained.
- Minimum distance from the nearest office: 1.5 km in cities with population of 20 lakh and above; 2 km in other urban areas.
- No Extra-Departmental (ED) post offices are to be opened in urban areas in future.
- The Head of Circle may personally relax the distance condition in up to 10% of cases (this power is not to be delegated).

Chapter 3 — Panchayat Sanchar Sewa Yojana (PSSY)

Introduced with effect from 30 September 1995 to provide basic postal services at Gram Panchayat headquarters that lack a post office (DG No. 1-25/94-95/PSSK/PLG dated 11.09.1995). The services are provided through a Sanchar Kendra Agent (SKA) engaged by the Gram Panchayat.

3.1 Sanchar Kendra Agent (SKA) — Qualifications

- Passed the Matriculation examination (10th class).
- Aged between 18 and 62 years on the date of appointment (not retained beyond 65 years).
- Of good moral character, with no criminal case pending.
- Appointed by the Gram Panchayat with the written consent of the SP/SSP.

3.2 Functions of the Panchayat Kendra

- Sale of postage stamps and stationery.
- Booking of registered letters (excluding VP and insured articles).
- Mahila Samridhi Yojana (MSY) accounts, where feasible.
- Collection, conveyance and delivery of mail within the Gram Panchayat village, where feasible.
- Operation of an STD/PCO/Panchayat phone, if eligible.

3.3 Allowance Structure

Item	Rate
Fixed monthly allowance	₹500 per month
Commission on stamps — normal rural areas	5% of sale value
Commission on stamps — hilly/tribal (up to ₹100)	5%
Commission on stamps — hilly/tribal (₹101–200)	7.5%
Commission on stamps — hilly/tribal (₹201 and above)	10%
Commission per registered letter booked	50 paise

The fixed allowance is paid on the first working day of each month; incentive/commission payments follow one month later.

Chapter 4 — Standards for Opening a Departmental Sub-Office (Postal Sector Plan)

Sub-offices may be opened under the plan scheme “Expansion of Postal Network” in project areas, industrial estates, new townships and satellite colonies (DG Posts Lr. No. 1-15/90-Plg dated 10.04.1991). All proposals are routed by Circles to the Planning Branch of the Directorate for the approval of the Secretary, Ministry of Finance (Department of Expenditure). The minimum workload required is 5 hours by the Marathe Time Test (excluding sub-accounts / accounts work).

4.1 Maximum Permissible Loss Limits

Area	Maximum Permissible Loss (₹/year)
Normal rural areas	₹2,400
Hilly / backward / tribal areas	₹4,800

Chapter 5 — Norms for Delivery Post Offices

Laid down by DG Posts Lr. No. 1-36/87-PRS dated 01.06.1990:

- A minimum of 7 postmen must be justified on the existing basis.
- A well-demarcated delivery jurisdiction is required to minimise errors in TD (transferred/despatch) sorting.
- No minimum distance is required between the proposed delivery office and the nearest existing delivery office.
- Heads of Circles (PMsG / CPMsG) may relax the 7-postmen minimum for new townships, estates and colonies.

Chapter 6 — Revision of Allowances of Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS)

The allowances of GDS are now governed by the Kamlesh Chandra Committee Report, implemented with effect from 01.07.2018, which replaced the earlier Nataraja Murthy Committee structure of 2006. This is one of the most heavily tested topics, so the current position is set out in full.

UPDATE NOTE

The GDS wage structure moved from the *Nataraja Murthy Committee Report (01.01.2006)* to the *Kamlesh Chandra Committee Report (w.e.f. 01.07.2018)*, notified through the Department of Posts' Resolution No. 17-13/2013-GDS and connected orders.

6.1 New Wage Structure — Key Features

The old Point System for the assessment of BPM workload has been abolished. The eleven earlier TRCA slabs have been subsumed into three wage scales with two levels each — Level 1 (4 hours) and Level 2 (5 hours). The minimum working hours were raised from 3 hours to 4 hours; the maximum is 5 hours. The rate of annual increase is 3%.

UPDATE NOTE

The earlier complex fitment (multiplier of 1.74 with 40% fitment at the 20th stage) was replaced by the abolition of the Point System and the two-level (4 & 5 hour) structure under the Kamlesh Chandra Committee.

6.2 TRCA Slabs — GDS Categories

Category	Work Hours/Day	Minimum TRCA
GDS Branch Postmaster (BPM) — Level 1	Up to 4 hours	₹12,000
GDS Branch Postmaster (BPM) — Level 2	Up to 5 hours	₹14,500
Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM) / Dak Sevak — Level 1	Up to 4 hours	₹10,000
Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM) / Dak Sevak — Level 2	Up to 5 hours	₹12,000

6.3 Other Allowances

A single Composite Allowance has been introduced, replacing the earlier fragmented maintenance allowances. It provides support for hiring accommodation (for the BO and mandatory residence), office maintenance, and mobile and electricity charges. In addition, Children Education Allowance (₹6,000 per child per annum) and a Risk &

Hardship Allowance (₹500 per month in special areas) were introduced, and a financial upgradation is granted at 12, 24 and 36 years of service.

UPDATE NOTE

The older Office Maintenance Allowance (OMA ₹100), Fixed Stationery Charge (₹25), Boat Allowance and CDA were replaced by the single Composite Allowance under the Kamlesh Chandra Committee.

6.4 Service Discharge Benefits

Benefit	Maximum / Rate
GDS Gratuity	Maximum ₹1,50,000
Severance Amount	₹4,000 per completed year of service (maximum ₹1,50,000)
Service Discharge Benefit Scheme (SDBS)	Monthly contribution of ₹300 credited to the Permanent Retirement Account (PRA)

VERIFIED (CURRENT)

Verified current: the enhancement to GDS Gratuity (max ₹1,50,000), Severance (₹4,000/year, max ₹1,50,000) and SDBS (₹300/month) was ordered vide DoP OM No. 17-31/2016-GDS (Social Security Benefits for GDS), effective 01.07.2018, and remains in force. Earlier position: Ex-gratia Gratuity ₹60,000; Severance ₹1,500/year (max ₹60,000).

Chapter 7 — Calculation of Income and Cost of a Post Office

7.1 Income Apportionment Fractions

When testing whether an office is justified, only a defined fraction of certain revenues is credited to it, because a single transaction is shared between the office of posting and the office of delivery.

Item	Rural PO	Urban PO
Stamp revenue — delivery office	2/5th of value	43/120th of value
Stamp revenue — dispatch office	20% of the above	37/120th of value
Unpaid postage — delivery	3/4th	5/7th
Unpaid postage — posted	1/8th	5/42nd
Money Order commission — issued	24%	24%
Money Order commission — paid	38%	38%

7.2 Cost Components

- Establishment cost — pay and allowances of all staff.
- Rent, rates and taxes.
- Stationery and forms.
- Line / telephone charges.
- Overhead and administrative charges.

Chapter 8 — Fixed Stationery Charges (FSC) and Related Allowances

Revised vide Directorate letter No. 23-1/2008-PAP dated 02.12.2010:

Category	Rate
Bag sealing wax	₹3 per bag per day
Candles	₹8 per month
Supervisory staff	₹4 per month
Clerical staff (PA/SA)	₹6 per month
Postmen	₹5 per month
Inspectors / ASPs (independent charge)	₹200 per month
Fixed Monetary Compensation (FMC) — single postman / combination beat	₹50 per day
FMC — two postmen sharing	₹24 per day
Holiday Monetary Compensation (Supervisor/PA/Postman)	₹85 per holiday
Holiday Monetary Compensation (MTS)	₹60 per holiday

Chapter 10 — Review of Post-Office Establishment

A combined procedure for all categories of periodical review took effect from 1 April 2003:

Category of Office	Review Frequency
Head Post Offices (HOs) and MDGs	Annually
LSG / HSG Sub-Offices, Class I SOs, other T/SOs	Every 3 years
GDS establishment revision	Every 3 years
Branch Offices (BOs)	Triennially, at the time of SO/HO inspection; also at the annual BO inspection (clarified 03.07.2014)

Part II — Marathe Time Test & CSI Norms (Post Offices)

The Marathe Time Test (MTT) provides standardised time factors — in minutes per operation — for calculating the workload and staff requirement of a post office. Each department carries a coefficient that accounts for rest, fatigue and incidental work. With computerisation, several manual factors have been replaced by Core System Integrator (CSI) point-of-sale norms measured in seconds; both are shown so that either can be applied.

UPDATE NOTE

The framework has moved from exclusive reliance on the Marathe Time Test to the integration of Core System Integrator (CSI) workload norms for computerised operations under the India Post IT Modernisation Project. The manual factors are retained for study and for offices/operations still assessed manually.

Chapter 11 — Establishment of Post Office (MTT) — Postal Assistants

11.1 Mails Department

Operation	Time Factor (min)
Bags received	0.25
Bags dispatched	0.20
Transit bags (TBs) opened	0.20
Transit bags closed	0.75
Mails Department coefficient	1.10

11.2 Sorting Department

Operation	Time Factor (min)
Articles received in sorting	0.06
Articles posted (fully sorted)	0.08
Mail bags closed	2.50
Sorting Department coefficient	1.14

11.3 Delivery Department

Operation	Time Factor (min)
Paid articles received	0.16
Delivery Department coefficient	1.20

11.4 Registration Department

Operation	Time Factor
Registered letters booked	1.50 min (manual) / 60–90 sec (CSI POS)
Registered letters issued to postmen	1.20 – 1.40 min
Registration Department coefficient	1.25
UPDATE NOTE Under the CSI Point-of-Sale (POS) system the booking of a registered letter is measured at 60–90 seconds instead of the manual 1.50 minutes.	

11.5 Special Registered Articles

Article Type	Operation	Time Factor (min)
Insured envelopes	Posted inland	7.20
Insured envelopes	Issued to postmen	3.50
VP articles	Posted inland	3.70
VP articles	Received for delivery	2.75
VP articles	Delivered	2.70
Parcels	Posted inland	2.60
Parcels	Issued to postmen	2.50
Parcels Department coefficient		1.30

11.6 Speed Post Norms

Operation	Time Factor
Speed Post booking	82–188 seconds per article (CSI POS)
Speed Post dispatch	0.4 min per article
Speed Post receipt	0.2 min per article
Speed Post issued to postman	1 min per article
Speed Post delivery on moped	110 articles/day (4.5 hrs delivery + 1.5 hrs to traverse 18 km)

NOTE:

Two separate things are often confused here — keep them apart:

(a) **Workload norm.** The 82–188 seconds figure is an internal CSI-POS booking time factor. It is reproduced as a study figure and is **not** derived from any gazette notification.

(b) **Service revision.** Gazette Notification No. 4256 dated 25.09.2025 (effective 01.10.2025) revised the Speed Post *tariff* (first revision since October 2012) and introduced OTP-based

Operation	Time Factor
secure delivery, online booking and payment, SMS alerts, real-time tracking, a Registration value-added service (₹5 + GST), a 10% student discount and a 5% new-bulk-customer discount. That gazette does not fix any per-article workload time.	

11.7 Computerised Registration Centre (CRC) Norms — revised 17.01.2013

Operation	Time Factor
Scanning / receipt at CRC	0.04 min per article
Sorting at CRC	0.079 min per article
Revised Speed Post processing	1,000 articles per SA per day (8-hour day)

11.8 Money Order Department

Operation	Time Factor (min)	Coefficient (HO/SO)
TMO issued (foreign sterling)	10.00	
TMO issued (others)	9.00	
TMO paid	7.00	
Ordinary MO issued	3.50	
Ordinary MO paid	2.50	
IPO sold	2.00	
IPO paid	2.50	
MO coefficient — HO		1.40
MO coefficient — SO		1.25

11.9 Sub-Account Department

Type of Sub-Office	Time Factor (min)
Non-delivery / single-handed SO	30.00
Other SOs	40.00
BO in direct account (per BO)	20.00
Village postman attendance per week (per postman)	5.00
Remittance of cash or stamps per occasion	5.00

11.10 Treasury Department

Cash Receipt Range	Time Factor
Daily average up to ₹10,000 from counters	9 min per ₹1,000 (fractions rounded to nearest ₹500)
Excess over ₹10,000 up to ₹40,000	90 min for first ₹10,000 + 9 min per ₹2,000 in excess
Excess over ₹40,000 up to ₹1 lakh	225 min for first ₹40,000
Bank transactions (first ₹25,000)	45 min
Bank transactions (each additional ₹25,000)	15 min
Cash to postmen (per postman)	10 min
Remittance of cash to subordinate offices	10 min per remittance
Stamps supply/sale in bulk (per ₹1,000)	18 min

11.11 Staff Hours and Additional PA Sanction

Duty Type	Hours
Stretch duty	7.5 hours per day
Split duty	6.75 hours per day

An additional Postal Assistant is sanctioned when the unprovided work reaches:

Class of SO	Unprovided Work (Hours)
"C" class SO	2.5 hours and above
"B" class SO	4 hours and above
Other offices	5 hours and above

11.12 Mail Transmission / Delivery Standards

Route	Standard
Local delivery	D + 1
Within district	D + 2
Within state	D + 2 to D + 3
Other states	D + 3 to D + 5

Part III — Savings Bank & Savings Certificates

This Part covers the workload norms for Post Office Savings Bank (POSB) and savings-certificate work. Manual (Marathe) factors are shown for study, but the operative measurement is now the Core Banking Solution (CBS) / Finacle transaction time, expressed in seconds.

Chapter 12 — Establishment of PO Savings Bank / Savings Certificates

12.1 Head Post Office — SB Norms (Manual)

Operation	Time (min)	Coefficient
New SB account (at counter)	9.00	
Deposit at HO	3.75	
Withdrawal at HO	5.50	
HO coefficient		1.85

12.2 Sub Post Office — SB Norms (Manual)

Operation	Time (min)	Coefficient
New SB account at SO	9.00	
Deposit at SO	3.00	
Withdrawal at SO	5.30	
SO coefficient		1.45

12.3 Core Banking Solution (CBS) / Finacle Norms

Operation	Time (seconds)
CIF creation	171 seconds
New SB / PPF account	76 seconds
Deposit	51 seconds
Withdrawal	53 – 97 seconds
Account closure	89 – 95 seconds

UPDATE NOTE

The measurement moved from the computerised Meghdoot norms (w.e.f. 26.02.2008, measured in minutes — e.g. new SB account 7.00 min) to CBS/Finacle point-of-sale norms measured in seconds, following the CBS/CSI workload reassessment. All POSB operations are now on Finacle.

12.4 Recurring Deposit (RD)

Operation	Time (min)	Coefficient
RD opening at HO (payroll)	5.00	
RD opening at HO (others)	8.00	
HO coefficient for RD		1.60
SO coefficient for RD		1.30

12.5 NSC / KVP

Operation	Time (min)	Coefficient (HO/SO)
NSC / KVP issued	7.00	
NSC / KVP discharged	8.00	
HO coefficient		1.80
SO coefficient		1.40

12.6 Time Deposit

Operation	Time (min)	Coefficient
New Time Deposit account	10.00	
Time Deposit coefficient		1.35

Part IV — Philatelic Bureau & Postmen

Chapter 13 — Standards for Philatelic Bureau

Operation	Time Factor
Advance machine cancellation (FDCs)	37.5 min per 100 FDCs
Sale of philatelic stamps (other days)	0.40 min per rupee
Sale of philatelic stamps (date of issue)	0.33 min per rupee
Opening philatelic deposit account (inland)	18 min
Opening philatelic deposit account (foreign)	22 min
Supervisory work ratio (of total operative clerical work)	0.12

Criteria for opening a philatelic counter: (a) the location is an important or tourist centre; and (b) the average 14-day sale is ₹1,000 or more.

Chapter 14 — Postmen Establishment

Revised norms per File No. 9-1/2005-WS-I/PE-I dated 05.02.2010.

14.1 Delivery Time Factors

Mail Type	Time Factor (min/article)
Unregistered mail delivery (all areas)	0.72
Registered / parcel mail	2.50
Value Payable / customs-duty articles	3.00
Money Orders paid	3.85
Speed Post articles	2.50
Insured articles	3.50
Return by postman	Tracked via the Postman Mobile App (PMA)

UPDATE NOTE

The fixed “return by postman” allowance (previously a maximum of 20 minutes/day) has been replaced by real-time capture through the Postman Mobile App (PMA) under the Delivery & Postman Management System (DPMS).

14.2 Walking / Cycling Distance Norms

Mode / Area Type	Time per km
On foot — congested area (density $\geq 2,500/\text{sq.km}$)	19 min/km
On foot — less congested area	15 min/km

Mode / Area Type	Time per km
Bicycle — congested area	10 min/km
Bicycle — less congested area	8 min/km

14.3 Staff Hours

Beat Type	Staff Hours/Day
Single beat	450 min (7.5 hours)
Two batches	420 min (7 hours)

14.4 Sorting Postman & Cash Overseer

- Sorting Postman: 450 articles per hour.
- Cash Overseer: total work hours $\div$ (450 $\times$ 25); walking a maximum of 24 km per day.

Chapter 15 — Stamp Vendors

Sale per Transaction	Time Factor
Less than ₹10	18 seconds per rupee
₹10 to ₹30	6 seconds per rupee

Average Daily Sale	Type of Vendor Justified
₹600 per day	1 GDS Stamp Vendor (3 hours workload)
Up to ₹1,000 per day	1 GDS Stamp Vendor (5 hours workload)
Above ₹1,000 per day	1 Departmental Stamp Vendor

UPDATE NOTE

“ED Stamp Vendor” is now “Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS) Stamp Vendor” under the GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules. The assessment period considered is 4 months (instead of a 14-day average), per DG Posts No. 31-15/83-PE-I dated 07.10.1986.

Part V — Core System Integrator (CSI) Norms

Applicable to all computerised HPOs under the IT Modernisation Project. CSI unifies the earlier stand-alone applications onto a single SAP-based platform, so the workload is now measured directly from system operations, in seconds.

UPDATE NOTE

The earlier Meghdoot LAN norms have been superseded by the Core System Integrator (CSI) norms under the India Post IT Modernisation Project.

Chapter 16 — CSI Module Norms

16.1 SAP F&A / Treasury Module

Operation	CSI Norm (sec)
Opening CSI Cash Office	720
CSD receipt (per denomination)	20
Count 100 pieces subsequently	120
Remittance from SO/BO — data creation	15 / office
Cash to postmen (per postman, viewing screen)	10 / beat
Return from postmen	13 / PM
Bank remittance — below ₹5 lakh	7,200
Bank remittance — ₹5–20 lakh	10,800
Bank remittance — above ₹20 lakh	12,600
Closing CSI Cash Office (up to ₹20 lakh)	3,600
Closing CSI Cash Office (above ₹20 lakh)	4,800

16.2 Point of Sale (POS) Module

Operation	CSI Norm (sec)
Registered letter booking (computerised)	90
Speed Post booking with acknowledgement	82
Ordinary eMO issued	90
IPO sale	128
Booking Air Mail RL	90
PLI premium acceptance	120
Telephone Revenue Collection (MTNL/BSNL)	75

16.3 DPMS / Postman Module

Operation	CSI Norm (sec)
RL issued to postman for delivery	72 (65 viewing screen)
Registered parcel issued to postman	116
MO issued to postman for delivery	122
TMO issued to postman	210
Window delivery of MO	120
Window delivery of RL	70

16.4 IPVS / Despatch Module

Operation	Time Factor
Dispatch of Registered / VP articles	16 sec per article
Registered bags closed	75 sec per bag

16.5 MO Compilation Module

Operation	CSI Norm
MO issue compilation	14 sec / MO
MO paid compilation	32 sec / MO
Coefficient	1.40

16.6 SAP / Sub-Account Module

Type of Office	CSI Norm (sec)
No-delivery / single-handed SO	1,320
Branch Post Office	900
Other sub-offices	1,620

Part VI — Supervisory Posts in Post Offices

Chapter 17 — Supervisory Posts in Post Offices

Supervisory work hours are obtained by multiplying the operative work hours of each department by the relevant supervisory ratio. This calculation applies when the number of Postal Assistants is 5 or more.

17.1 Supervisory Ratios (Operative Work Hours × Ratio)

Department / Function	Ratio
Mails	0.07
Sorting	0.08
Delivery	0.08
Registration — delivery office	0.15
Registration — no-delivery office	0.10
Parcel — delivery office	0.13
Parcel — no-delivery office	0.10
Money Order — delivery office	0.20
Money Order — no-delivery office	0.15
Savings Bank	0.25
Savings Certificates (NSC/KVP)	0.25
Sale of Units	0.10
Sub-Account	0.17
Accounts in HOs	0.17
Treasury	0.12

17.2 Small Offices (Fewer Than 5 PAs)

Office Strength	Supervisory Hours Allowed
Single-handed (1 PA)	Nil
Double-handed (2 PAs)	1 hour
3 PAs	1 hour 50 min
4 PAs	2 hours 30 min

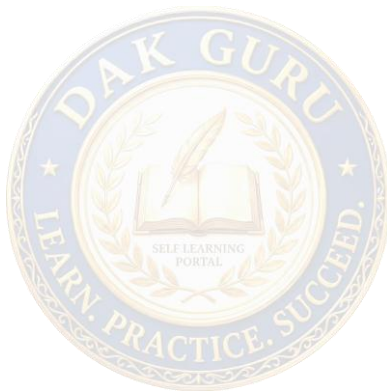
17.3 HSG Grades

- HSG-II: a post office having 2 to 5 LSG supervisors.
- HSG-I: a post office having more than 6 LSG supervisors.

NOTE:

The rigid LSG-dependent formation has been overtaken by the Cadre Restructuring of Group 'C' employees, which fixes supervisory posts as a percentage of sanctioned PA strength.

Corrected figures: the approved cadre-restructuring ratios are **LSG 22%, HSG-II 12%, and HSG-I 4%** of the sanctioned strength.



Part VII — Accounts Branch (HPO & HRO)

Chapter 18 — Accounts Branch in HPO (Madan Kishore Formula)

UPDATE NOTE

The theoretical Madan Kishore time factors are retained for study, but establishment-bill and payroll processing is now handled automatically by the CSI SAP HR / F&A modules under the IT Modernisation Project.

18.1 Key Time Factors — Operative Work

Item of Work	Time Factor (min)
Increment / absentee statement	7.30 per entry
Establishment bill (all classes/types)	10.00 per entry
Acquittance rolls	4.00 per entry
Leave cases	8.00 per case
Leave calculation	3.00 per calculation
Leave certificate	2.30 per case
Entry in leave account	2.30 per entry
Annual verification of service	12.00 per SB or SR
Income-tax calculation	25.00 per official
Register maintenance (various)	2.00 per entry

18.2 GDS Conversion Rates in Establishment Bill

Percentage of GDS in Office	Rate — Bill Entry	Rate — Acquittance Roll
Less than 10% GDS	12.30 min/entry	5.00 min/entry
Between 10% and 30% GDS	11.15 min/entry	4.30 min/entry

UPDATE NOTE

“Extra-Departmental Agents (EDA)” are now “Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)” throughout, per the DoP nomenclature revision.

18.3 Supervisory and Miscellaneous Work

- Supervisory work: 20% of operative work hours.
- Miscellaneous (coefficient for misc. work): 10% of work hours.

Chapter 19 — Revised SIU-Approved Norms for Accounts Branch

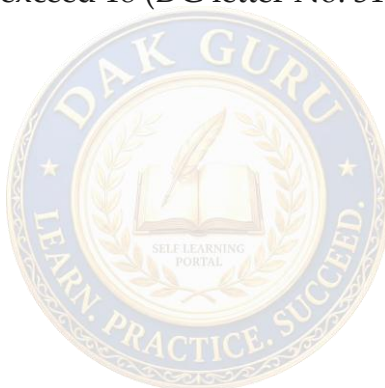
19.1 Conversion Rate — GDS to Departmental Staff

Category	Condition	Conversion Rate
HPO	Less than 50% GDS	0.25
HPO	50% or more but less than 100% GDS	0.20
HPO	100% or more GDS	0.15
HRO	All cases (uniform)	0.25

19.2 Operative Work Provision

Office Type	Operative Work per Employee per Day
Head Post Offices (HPO)	0.056 work-hours/day/departmental employee
Head Record Offices (HRO)	0.050 work-hours/day/departmental employee

LSG Accountant posts: the 1st post for the first 7 clerks; the 2nd post when clerks reach 12; the 3rd post when clerks exceed 18 (DG letter No. 31-26/82-PE-I dated 31.05.1985).



Part VIII — Savings Bank Control Organisation (SBCO)

Chapter 21 — SBCO Standards

UPDATE NOTE

Manual SBCO register maintenance has been largely superseded by the Central Processing Centre (CPC) and CBS-Finacle automated General Ledger (GL) integration. The clerical standards below are retained for study; in practice most checks are now systemic Finacle validations.

21.1 Supervisory Posts in SBCO

Active Accounts	Supervisory Post
Up to 35,000	UDC as in-charge (with special pay)
35,001 to 1,05,000	1 LSG Head Clerk
1,05,001 to 1,75,000	1 HSG-II Head Clerk + 1 LSG
Above 1,75,000	1 HSG-I + 1 LSG

21.2 Clerical Standards — Key Time Factors

Operation	Time Factor
Receipt & distribution of documents (100 offices)	16 min
Examination of transaction lists (100 transactions)	55 min
Maintenance of SB 62(a) register and transfer (100 transactions)	266 min
Maintenance of SB 62 register (100 binders)	25 min posting + 25 min checking
Checking HO transactions (100 transactions)	300 min
General check of withdrawals (100 withdrawals)	40 min

21.3 Automated Account Listing

UPDATE NOTE

The old Ascota / Burroughs listing machines have been entirely phased out; account listing is now through CBS system-generated MIS reports.

Part IX — Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS) Establishment

Chapter 24 — MTS Establishment

UPDATE NOTE

The erstwhile Group 'D' posts have been upgraded to Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS), Group 'C', following the 6th and 7th CPC recommendations.

24.1 Mail Attendants & Letter-Box Attendants — Time Factors

Operation	Time Factor (min)
Cleaning stamps/seals and change of date/hour type	2 min per stamp/seal
Exchange of mails including loose parcels	0.5 min per bag/parcel (min. 10 min per exchange)
Opening of bags (all types)	1 min per bag
Closing of bags	4 min per bag
Unregistered articles in double sorting	0.11 min per article
Stitching & stamping of lists (HO)	0.05 min per receipt
Stitching & stamping of lists (SO)	0.12 min per receipt
Stamping of MOs issued	0.10 min per MO
Stamping of blank MO forms for sale	0.05 min per form
Stamping of unpaid articles	0.11 min per article
Stamping of prepaid articles (cash)	0.025 min per article

24.2 MTS (Packers) Norms

Office Strength	MTS Sanctioned
More than 10, not exceeding 25 officials	3 MTS for the first 10 + 1 per 5 officials above 10
More than 25 officials	The above for the first 25 + 1 per 7 officials above 25

24.3 Sweepers

- Building area: 1 hour per 1,250 sq.ft.
- Compound area: 1 hour per 2,000 sq.ft.

24.4 Waterman

1 Waterman per 100 officials in an office.

24.5 Chowkidar

Condition (average overnight cash/stamp balance)	Type of Chowkidar
Above ₹75,000	Part-time Chowkidar
Above ₹1,50,000	Departmental Chowkidar

Departmental Chowkidar duty: 48 hours/week. GDS Chowkidar: a maximum of 5 hours/day (under the Kamlesh Chandra norms).

24.6 Gardener

1 Gardener per 1.5 acres of garden area.

24.7 Redesignation of Group 'D'

The erstwhile Group 'D' was redesignated as MTS (Multi-Tasking Staff), Group 'C', vide Directorate letter No. 1-20/2008-PCC dated 24.09.2010. The "Packer" designation was changed to "Peon" in administrative/subordinate offices and to "Mail Peon" in FPOs.

UPDATE NOTE

For sweepers, watermen, chowkidars and gardeners, the trend is towards contractual/outsourced services under the Ministry of Finance guidelines on outsourcing non-core activities; creation of fresh departmental posts in these categories is restricted.



Part X — Mail Offices (RMS)

The Railway Mail Service establishment was traditionally assessed by the Marathe Time Test for Sorting Assistants and by the Molinder Singh points formula for Mail Guards. With the Mail Network Optimisation Project (MNOP), the India Post Visibility System (IPVS) and the Road Transport Network (RTN), assessment now rests largely on barcode scanning volumes and route mapping.

UPDATE NOTE

Assessment has moved from the Marathe Time Test for Sorting Assistants to India Post Visibility System (IPVS) and Parcel Network Optimisation Project (PNOP) norms under the Directorate's Mail Network Optimisation Project.

Chapter 25 — Establishment of Mail Offices (IPVS & PNOP Norms)

25.1 Mails Department — Receipt and Dispatch

Operation	Time Factor
Bags received (IPVS scanning)	15 seconds
Bags dispatched (IPVS scanning)	15 seconds
Parcels received outside	10 seconds
Parcels dispatched outside	10 seconds
Mail bags opened	1.50 min
Mail bags closed	2.50 min
Unregistered articles received in sorting	0.10 min
Articles posted for dispatch	0.12 min

UPDATE NOTE

The manual entry norms (e.g. bags received 0.25 min) have been replaced by IPVS barcode-scanning norms.

25.2 Registration & Parcel Department (RMS)

Operation	Time Factor (min)
Registered articles dispatched	0.40
Registered bags (RBs) made up	1.50
Parcel bags received / dispatched	0.20
Parcel bags closed	2.00
Parcel bags opened	1.00

Operation	Time Factor (min)
Registered parcels received	0.35
Registered parcels dispatched	0.75
Insured bags opened	2.00
Insured bags closed	3.00
MO received in sorting	0.13
HVMO received in sorting	0.73

Chapter 26 — Mail Guards Establishment

Posts of Mail Guards and Head Mail Guards are assessed on IPVS bag-scanning and handling volumes at transit nodes and on Road Transport Network (RTN) routes.

Bag / Handling Type	IPVS Handling Norm
Packet bag / Letter (L) bag	15 seconds per scan
Mail / Parcel / Special bag	15 seconds per scan
Transit section justification	Based on RTN route mapping and NPH/SPH linkage

UPDATE NOTE

The Molinder Singh Formula points system (e.g. packet bag 1 point, L bag 2 points) has been replaced by IPVS scanning and RTN route mapping under the Mail Network Optimisation Project (MNOP).

Chapter 27 — Transit Mail Office (TMO) / Transit Section

Where mail exchange at a station requires physical transshipment without sorting, a Transit Mail Office may be opened on the basis of RTN schedule alignment. No traditional rail transit section is to be opened where operations have been entirely replaced by closed-body RTN vehicles.

UPDATE NOTE

The earlier threshold of 101 points has given way to RTN schedule alignment and the closed-body vehicle network under the Directorate's transport network reforms.

Chapter 28 — Travelling Mail Attendant (TMA) / Travelling Van Attendant (TVA)

A TMA/TVA is sanctioned for escorted RTN routes and for the remaining rail sections where the physical security of closed bags is mandated without intermediate mail-list preparation.

Chapter 29 — Supervisory Posts in Mail Offices

29.1 Cadre Restructuring Norms

Supervisory posts in RMS are allotted on the same Group 'C' cadre-restructuring basis as post offices, applied to the sanctioned Sorting Assistant strength.

NOTE:

The older rule of 1 LSG per 6 SAs within the time test has been replaced by standardised percentage-based cadre-restructuring ratios. As corrected in Part VI, the approved ratios are **LSG 22%, HSG-II 12%, HSG-I 4%** — verify against the current Directorate order before official use.

29.2 RMS Supervisory Ratios

Department	Ratio
Receipt / Dispatch (Mails)	0.07
Sorting	0.07
Registration	0.14
Parcel	0.14

Chapter 30 — Determination of Number of Sets of Sections

Parameter	Value
Maximum weekly working hours	42 hours
Minimum weekly working hours	36 hours
Coefficient for night duty (20:00 – 06:00 hrs)	20 min per hour
Platform attendance addition	0.30
RO attendance addition	0.30
Mail exchange addition	0.30 (0.15 + 0.15)
Total weekly hours for OTA purposes	192 hours for sections

Chapter 32 — Sub Record Office (Punjab Formula)

Operation	Time Factor
Opening of dak	2 min 30 sec
Communication of orders (per order)	10 min
Disbursement of pay (per official)	5 min
Maintenance of cash abstract	10 min

Chapter 33 — Accounts Branch of HRO

Establishment-bill processing, leave management and acquittance rolls are fully automated under the CSI SAP HR / F&A modules.

UPDATE NOTE

The Madan Kishore manual time factors (e.g. establishment bill 12.30 min/entry) have been superseded by automated payroll processing under the CSI SAP HR modules.

Chapter 34 — Formula for ASRM and IRM in Mail Offices

Strength	Posts Sanctioned
35 SAs in a set	1 Inspector Record Master (IRM)
55 SAs in a set	1 IRM + 1 Assistant SRM (ASRM)
Each additional 35 SAs	1 additional IRM
Set with HSG-II and more than 20 T/S SAs	1 ASRM

Chapter 35 — Platform Inspectors in RMS

Number of Officials on Platform	Post
1 to 29	No Platform Inspector post
30 to 49	1 Platform Inspector (T/S scale)
50 to 74	1 PI upgraded to IRM scale
130 and above	1 PI per additional 40 officials

Chapter 38 — Automated Mail Processing Centres (AMPCs)

Operation	Productivity Norm
VCD Operator (video coding)	2,200 articles/hour (10-min break every 2 hours)
AFF Operator (automated flat facing)	4,500 articles/hour
Culling / facing (bulk mail)	5,000 articles per man-hour
Culling / facing (other mail)	2,000 articles per man-hour
Manual induction — SAI (singulator automatic induction)	1,500 articles/hour
Manual induction — DOI	1,500 articles/hour
LSM Operator (letter sorting machine)	1 per machine
LSM Loader	3 trolleys per hour

Part XI — Divisional & Circle Office Establishment

Chapter 41 — Divisional Office Establishment (SIU Standard)

41.1 Justification of a Divisional Office

Condition	Justified
Total SIU score ≥ 0.9	Divisional Office justified
Score above 1.3	Additional ASP justified
RMS Division — score ≥ 1.0	Division justified
RMS Division — score ≥ 2.6	Bifurcation (split into two divisions)

41.2 Clerical Strength Formula

Clerical strength = $(\text{HOs} \times 0.200) + (\text{SOs} \times 0.050) + (\text{BOs} \times 0.002) + (\text{PAs} \times 0.010) + (\text{Postmen} \times 0.005) + (\text{MTS} \times 0.002) + (\text{GDS staff} \times 0.001)$.

UPDATE NOTE

“Group D” and “ED staff” in the original formula are now “Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS)” and “Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)” respectively.

41.3 Group ‘A’ Division Criteria

A division is classified as Group ‘A’ if it satisfies any one of the following:

- It contains 1 gazetted Head Office; OR
- It contains 3 or more non-gazetted HOs / HSG SOs; OR
- Its clerical strength exceeds 450.

Chapter 43 — Inspectors Establishment

Inspecting Unit	Coefficient
Head Post Office (HO)	0.023
Sub Post Office (SO)	0.012
SO in hilly areas	0.013
Branch Office (BO)	0.005
BO in hilly areas	0.006
Departmental staff (per official)	0.001
GDS staff (per official)	0.0004
Each sub-division formed	0.41

Each sub-division is based on an inspecting workload of 0.59.

UPDATE NOTE

“ED staff (0.0004)” is now “GDS staff (0.0004)” under the GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules.

Chapter 44 – Complaints Inspector

One Complaints Inspector per Division, irrespective of the volume of complaints. An additional post is justified if public complaints exceed 800 per month.

UPDATE NOTE

Manual counting of complaints has given way to workload distribution captured through the Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS) and the CRM portal.

Chapter 45 – Circle Office Establishment (SIU Standard)

45.1 Central Registry

1 clerk per 57,000 diarised communications per year.

45.2 Data Entry & Processing Standards

Data-entry speed of 8,000 Key Depressions Per Hour (KDPH) on computers.

UPDATE NOTE

The old typing standard (7,100 words per day, or 710 lines per day on a 7-hour working day) has been replaced by the data-entry standard of 8,000 KDPH, in line with DoPT guidelines on computerisation.

45.3 Establishment Section

Function	Standard
General establishment processing	1 clerk per 3,750 receipts per year
T/S SOs under review	1 clerk per 825 offices

45.4 PLI Section

UPDATE NOTE

The manual PLI time factors (e.g. PLI proposals 1 hr 20 min; death claims 2 hr 30 min) have been superseded by system-driven processing in the Core Insurance Solution (CIS) / McCamish portal under the PLI Directorate automation project.

45.5 Sectional Officers

1 Sectional Officer per 100 points (1,600 productive hours per year).

Part XII — Postmasters in Group 'A' & 'B' Head Post Offices

Chapter 51 — Standards for Postmasters in Group 'A' & 'B' HOs

51.1 Points Required for Conversion

Conversion Type	Points Required
Group 'A' (Deputy PM + APM combined)	11,000 points
Group 'B' HO	4,200 points
Additional Deputy PM (Group 'B')	1 per 2,200 points above base

51.2 Deputy PM (Gazetted — Group 'A') Point Calculation

Item	Points per Unit
T/S clerks	17 points per clerk
SBCO clerks	3 points per clerk
Fixed (PR / Grievance)	500 points (fixed)

51.3 APM (HSG — Group 'A') Point Calculation

Item	Points per Unit
T/S clerks under APM	37 points per clerk
Postmen supervision	7 points per postman

Chapter 52 — Conversion of an LSG SO into a Head Post Office

Each district should have one Head Office with a minimum of 20 sub-offices attached to it. Bifurcation is considered when the number of SOs exceeds 60, subject to the condition that neither resulting HO is left with fewer than 20 SOs.

Part XIII — Special Establishments

Chapter 57 — Investigating Inspectors of Complaints & Vigilance

One post per 8 Postal / RMS Divisions.

Chapter 58 — Pairing Organisation

Office Type	Standard
Circle Pairing	1 UDC per 1,600 credit-debit transfers per month
Central Pairing Office	1 UDC per 1,200 credit-debit transfers per month

Chapter 60 — Returned Letter Office (Marathe Time Test)

Article Type	Receipt / Disposal Time (min)	Supervisory Ratio
Unregistered articles	2.50 per article	0.11
Registered articles	8.00 per article	0.17
Parcels	12.00 per article	0.17

Establishment review: every 3 years (Directorate letter No. 25-03/2003-PE-I dated 04.12.2014).

Chapter 61 — Postal Stores Depot

Function	Standard
Clerical — invoice items	1 clerk per 4,900 invoice items/year
Clerical — transfer notices	1 clerk per 12,650 transfer notices/year
Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS)	6 Daftries + 20 MTS for approx. 600 indenting units

Review frequency: every 3 years.

UPDATE NOTE

“Group D” is now “Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS)” following the DoP nomenclature revision and the 6th/7th CPC recommendations.

Chapter 62 — Foreign Post Office

Operation	Time Factor / Ratio
Inward ordinary MO	7 min
Outward International Financial System (IFS) MO	4.10 min
Foreign letter mail (unregistered) — supervisory ratio	0.80 of operative work
Registered LM / CED — supervisory ratio	0.17
Parcel export — supervisory ratio	0.15

Operation	Time Factor / Ratio
PMO (Postal Money Order) — supervisory ratio	0.20

UPDATE NOTE

The outward sterling MO under the manual list system has been replaced by the Outward International Financial System (IFS) MO, following UPU IFS integration and Electronic Data Interchange (EDI) mandates. The manual sterling list system has been decommissioned.

Chapter 64 — Postal Training Centres

Post	Norms
Instructor	4 hours of class per day + 3 hours fixed items; teacher–taught ratio 1:20
Vice-Principal	24 min per trainee + 136 hours per PS Group 'B' session
Administrative Officer	1,057 hours per annum (fixed) + 16 min per trainee

Chapter 65 — Canteens and Tiffin Rooms

Strength	Category
15 to 49 officials	Tiffin Room B
50 to 99 officials	Tiffin Room A
100 to 249 officials	Canteen D
250 to 499 officials	Canteen C
500 to 699 officials	Canteen B
700 to 1,200 officials	Canteen A

Chapter 67 — Mail Motor Units (MMU)

Category	Coefficient / Norm
Administrative staff (major MMU with 51+ MMS vehicles)	0.020 per official
Technical staff per MMS vehicle	0.16 per vehicle
Leave reserve	10% of the staff worked out

Chapter 68 — Postal Machine Assistant

Machine Type	Machines per PMA per Year
Adding / listing machine	28
Digital franking / RMFS	52
Stamp cancelling machine	40

Chapter 69 — Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS)

Traditional mechanical and electronic franking machines have been phased out; standards now apply to Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS) models.

Machine Type	Capacity (Articles/Day)
RMFS low-volume desktop	3,000
RMFS medium-volume	5,000
RMFS high-speed commercial	10,000

UPDATE NOTE

Hand-operated, electrically-operated and high-speed franking machines have been replaced by RMFS digi-franking under the India Post franking machine phase-out guidelines and RMFS implementation.

Chapter 70 — Departmental Libraries

Function	Standard
Physical verification of books	200 min per 100 books
Shelving of books	3 hours per 100 books
Reference work (small collection, up to 5,000 books)	200 man-hours added
Reference work (medium / large collection)	400 man-hours added



Part XIV — Public Relations Inspectors & Miscellaneous

Chapter 22 — Norms for Creation of Posts of PRI (Postal)

Revised norms fixed by the Internal Work Unit (Postal). The requirement is worked out by applying the coefficients below to the relevant counts and adding the fixed component.

22.1 PRI(P) Attached to Presidency GPOs

Factor	Coefficient
Fixed and miscellaneous	0.53135
Per Postman / GDS Delivery Agent	0.00058
Per LB Attendant / GDS LB Attendant	0.00378
Per complaint / enquiry	0.00029
Per verification of claim	0.00009
Per court attendance	0.00340
Per local journey	0.000114

UPDATE NOTE

“EDDA (Extra-Departmental Delivery Agent)” and “EDLB” are now “GDS Delivery Agent” and “GDS LB Attendant” respectively.

22.2 PRI(P) for First-Class HOs (Group ‘A’ Postmaster)

Factor	Coefficient
Fixed and miscellaneous	0.51628
Per Postman / GDS Delivery Agent	0.00120

22.3 PRI(P) for Other Offices

Factor	Coefficient
Fixed and miscellaneous	0.52135
Per Postman / GDS Delivery Agent	0.00120

Chapter 55 — Sorting Assistants & Sorting Inspectors in Circle Office

Post	Norm
Sorting Assistant	0.53 per RMS Division
Sorting Inspector	0.34 per RMS Division

Part XV — Quick Reference: Key Norms at a Glance

This Part condenses the most frequently tested figures. It is a revision aid only — the detailed conditions and exceptions are in the chapters above.

A. Population & Distance Norms

Norm	Normal Area	Hilly / Tribal / Desert
Population (rural BO)	3,000	500 (single village) or 1,000 (group)
Distance from nearest PO	3 km	3 km (may be relaxed)
Income as % of cost	33⅓%	15%
Urban PO distance (cities ≥ 20 lakh pop.)	1.5 km	—
Urban PO distance (other cities)	2 km	—

B. Review Periods

Office / Establishment	Review Period
Head Post Offices, MDGs	Annual
LSG / HSG SOs, Class I SOs, T/SOs	Every 3 years
GDS establishment	Every 3 years
Branch Offices (BOs)	Triennial / annual BO inspection
Returned Letter Office (RLO)	Every 3 years
Postal Stores Depot	Every 3 years

C. Key MTT & CSI Coefficients — Post Offices

Department	Coefficient / Standard
Mails	1.10
Sorting	1.14
Delivery	1.20
Registration	1.25 (manual) / POS 60–90 sec
Parcels	1.30
Money Order — Head Office	1.40
Money Order — Sub Post Office	1.25
Savings Bank — HO / SO	Manual 1.85 / 1.45 — now CBS-Finacle measured
NSC / KVP — HO / SO	Manual 1.80 / 1.40 — now CBS-Finacle measured

Department	Coefficient / Standard
Recurring Deposit — HO / SO	Manual 1.60 / 1.30 — now CBS-Finacle measured
Time Deposit	1.35 (manual)
MO Compilation (CSI)	1.40
UPDATE NOTE For all POSB products the manual coefficients are retained for study, but operative measurement is now through CBS/Finacle transaction times (Chapter 12.3) under the IT Modernisation Project.	

D. Postmen Delivery Standards

Category	Rate / Norm
Unregistered mail delivery	0.72 min/article
Registered mail	2.50 min/article
Speed Post	2.50 min/article
Money Orders paid	3.85 min/article
VP / customs-duty articles	3.00 min/article
Insured articles	3.50 min/article
Walking speed (foot, congested)	19 min/km
Walking speed (foot, less congested)	15 min/km
Cycling speed (congested)	10 min/km
Cycling speed (less congested)	8 min/km
Daily staff hours (single beat)	450 min (7.5 hrs)

E. GDS Key Thresholds

Category	Work Hours/Day	Minimum TRCA
GDS Branch Postmaster (BPM) — Level 1	Up to 4 hours	₹12,000
GDS Branch Postmaster (BPM) — Level 2	Up to 5 hours	₹14,500
ABPM / Dak Sevak — Level 1	Up to 4 hours	₹10,000
ABPM / Dak Sevak — Level 2	Up to 5 hours	₹12,000
GDS Gratuity	—	Max ₹1,50,000
Severance Amount	—	₹4,000/yr (max ₹1,50,000)
SDBS contribution	—	₹300 per month
UPDATE NOTE		

Category	Work Hours/Day	Minimum TRCA
The 11 point-based TRCA slabs (e.g. 75 points, 100 points; unregistered articles 25/day = 1 point) were abolished and mapped to the two-level time-based TRCA structure under the Kamlesh Chandra Committee Report, effective 01.07.2018.		

F. Mail Guard Handling — IPVS Norms

Item / Bag Type	Handling Norm
Packet bag / Letter (L) bag	15 seconds per scan
Mail / Parcel / Special bag	15 seconds per scan
Transit section	Based on RTN route mapping

G. SBCO Supervisory Thresholds

The active-account thresholds in Chapter 21.1 remain the study answer, but in practice supervisory structures are administered under the Central Processing Centre (CPC) jurisdiction with automated Finacle General Ledger integration; the physical listing-machine norms are obsolete.



Study Notes on Currency & Verification

Because this subject is examined on the basis of the departmental reference material, candidates should be prepared to answer both the older and the current position where a change has occurred. The Update Notes throughout show both. The following points deserve particular attention:

- **GDS is the highest-yield update.** The abolition of the Point System, the two levels (4 and 5 hours), the four minimum TRCA figures, and the three social-security amounts are all confirmed current and are frequently tested.
- **Cadre restructuring percentages.** Use LSG 22% / HSG-II 12% / HSG-I 4%. Some circulating study material carries 14% and 8%, which do not match the sanctioned ratios.
- **Separate tariffs from workload norms.** The October 2025 Speed Post gazette changed tariffs and introduced OTP delivery and online booking; it did not change any per-article time factor. Questions on the two are distinct.
- **Technology transitions.** Meghdoot → CBS/Finacle, manual RMS → IPVVS/RTN, Ascota listing → CBS MIS, franking machines → RMFS, manual PLI → CIS/McCamish, Group 'D' → MTS, EDA/ED → GDS. These renaming and platform changes are easy marks.
- **Time factors and coefficients.** The Marathe, SIU, Madan Kishore and CSI per-operation figures are internal departmental standards not published in any public gazette. They are reproduced here as the established study figures; before using any of them in an actual establishment proposal, confirm against the current Directorate order.

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